

8. The rate of melting of Himalayan glaciers is:

- (a) Lowest in the world
- (b) Highest in the world
- (c) Same as of the glaciers of other parts of the world
- (d) No information is available about the melting rate of Himalayan glaciers

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (b)

The rate of melting of Himalayan Glaciers is highest in the world. The Gangotri Glacier from where river Ganga originates is melting very fast, due to which it has been reduced to half of its extent in the last 50 years.

9. Which one of the following glaciers is located in Kumaun region of Uttarakhand ?

- (a) Hispar
- (b) Zemu
- (c) Milam
- (d) Rupal

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (c)

Milam Glacier is a major glacier of the Kumaun region in Uttarakhand. Gori Ganga River (Kali River) originates from this glacier.

10. Consider the following pairs :

Glacier	River
1. Bandarpunch	: Yamuna
2. Bara Shigri	: Chenab
3. Milam	: Mandakini
4. Siachen	: Nubra
5. Zemu	: Manas

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) 1, 2 and 4
- (b) 1, 3 and 4
- (c) 2 and 5
- (d) 3 and 5

I.A.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

Mandakini river originates from Chorabari glacier. Zemu Glacier is the largest glacier in the Eastern Himalaya. It is about 26 kilometres in length and is located at the base of Kanchenjunga in the Himalayan region of Sikkim. The Manas River is transboundary river in Himalayan foothills between southern Bhutan & India. It is the most extensive river system in Bhutan. Besides Nubra, Yamuna & Chenab originate from several glaciers, i.e. Siachen, Bandarpunch & Bara Shigri.

11. Arrange the following glaciers in decreasing order of their lengths :

- (a) Biafo > Hispar > Sonapani > Bara Shigri > Drang Drung
- (b) Hispar > Drang Drung > Biafo > Sonapani > Bara Shigri

- (c) Hispar > Biafo > Drang Drung > Sonapani > Bara Shigri
- (d) Biafo > Hispar > Bara Shigri > Sonapani > Drang Drung

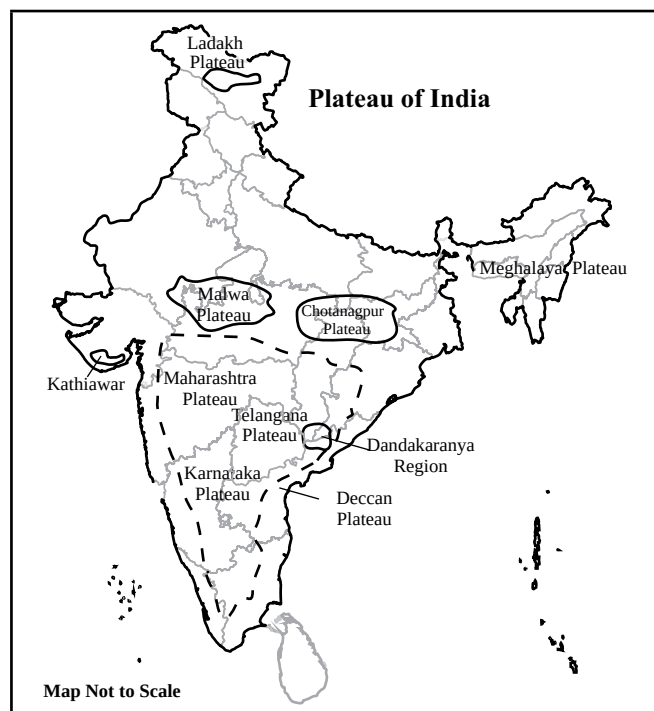
Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

The decreasing order of the lengths of the glaciers is- Hispar > Biafo > Drang Drung > Sonapani > Bara Shigri.

viii. Plateaus

*The Indian peninsula was formed around 3600 million years ago. Before the Carboniferous period it was a part of Gondwana's land. *In the Carboniferous period, coal was formed in the Damodar, Son, Mahanadi and Godavari basins whereas in Cretaceous period bulk of volcanic eruptions led to the formation of Deccan Traps. *The **Deccan Plateau** is a part of Indian shield. It is made up of basaltic lava. The Deccan trap was started to form approx. **66.25 million years ago**. The Peninsular Plateau consists of both broad and shallow valleys and round topped hills. *The peninsular plateau is basically divided into two parts- The **Central Highlands** and the **Deccan Plateau**. The part of the peninsular plateau lying to the north of the Narmada river, covering a major area of the Malwa Plateau is known as the Central Highlands. The Central Highlands are broad towards the west and start narrowing down towards the east. The eastward extension of the Central Highlands is sometimes locally known as **Bundelkhand** and **Baghelkhand**.



*The River Damodar Drains the **Chotanagpur Plateau** which is a part of central highlands. The Chotanagpur Plateau mainly extends from Ranchi in Jharkhand to Hazaribagh, Santhal Pargana, Palamu, Dhanbad, East and West Singhbhum districts, Purulia, Bankura, West Medinipur district of West Bengal and Mayurbhanj and Sundargarh districts of Odisha. *The Chotanagpur Plateau comprises various other plateaus of different heights. In the central western part of the Chotanagpur Plateau **pat land** is found, which has a maximum height of 1100 meters. All around this Plateau spans are found and the sharp break in slopes are marked by steep scarps. *The central highlands, consist of rivers like **Chambal, Sind, Betwa** and **Ken** which flow from south-west to northeast thus being a proving factor of the slope of the region. *The Malwa Plateau (length - 530 km, breadth - 390 km) covers approx 150000 km² area of Peninsular India. Its borders are determined by Aravalli in the North, Vindhya range in the south and Bundelkhand Plateau in the east.

*The Deccan Plateau is a triangular landform, situated south of the River Narmada. The Satpura ranges flank its broad base in the north are **Satpura Range** while **Mahadeo, Kaimur** and **Maikal ranges** form its eastern extension. The Deccan trap, where black soil or Regur is found which was formed as a result of weathering of lava (basalt) obtained by volcanic eruptions. Aravalli range is found in the Western and North Western parts of the Peninsular Plateau. The Aravalli Range is an eroded stub of ancient mountains and is the oldest range of fold mountains in India.

*A part of the Peninsular Plateau is also found in the northeastern part of our country. Locally they are called the **Meghalaya Plateau, Karbi-Anglong Plateau** and **North Cachar Hills**. This northeastern part of the Peninsular Plateau was separated from the mainland by Malda Gap due to faulting. There are three important hill complexes in the Meghalaya Plateau, named **Garo, Khasi** and **Jaintia** Hills respectively. The Dandakaranya region of **Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Telangana, Maharashtra** and **Andhra Pradesh** spreads across an area of 89078 km².

1. Basaltic Lava rocks over Indian Deccan Plateau were formed in which of the following period ?

- (a) Cretaceous period
- (b) Pleistocene period

- (c) Carboniferous period
- (d) Miocene period

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (a)

The origin of rocks of Peninsular India is about 3600 million years old . Before the Carboniferous Period, it was a part of Gondwanaland. It was during the Carboniferous period that coal was formed in the Damodar, Son, Mahanadi and Godavari basins. During the Cretaceous Period, large scale volcanic activity produced the Deccan Trap (the Lava Plateau of India) comprising Lava sheets of several thousand meters in depth. The Deccan Trap originated about 66.25 million years ago.

2. Meghalaya plateau is the part of –

- (a) Himalayan Range
- (b) Peninsular Plateau
- (c) Mountains of Eastern Ghats
- (d) Satpura Range

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

Meghalaya plateau is an extension of the Indian peninsular plateau. It was separated from the peninsular plateau by Malda Gap. Peninsular plateau is triangular in shape. It extends from plains of Uttar Pradesh and Bihar towards south and encompasses whole of the peninsula.

3. Extra peninsular mountains of India were formed during :

- (a) Eozoic Era
- (b) Palaeozoic Era
- (c) Mesozoic Era
- (d) Cenozoic Era

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

Extra peninsular mountains of India were formed in Cenozoic Era. Himalayan Ranges are an example of extra peninsular mountains of India.

4. Why is Dhanbad the most densely inhabited district of Chotanagpur plateau ?

- (a) Fertile soil and irrigational facilities by canals from the Damodar.
- (b) Availability of coal, iron ore, mica, copper etc.
- (c) Development of mining industries and industrialization.
- (d) All of the above.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (c)

Dhanbad comes under Chotanagpur plateau which is famous for coal mining and has some of the largest mines in India. Red soil is found in most of its region which is not useful for agriculture. The availability of coal, iron ore, mica etc. is not a good reason for population density.

5. Chota Nagpur Plateau –

- (a) Is a front sloping (b) Is a pitfall
(c) Is a foothill (d) Is a plain sub land

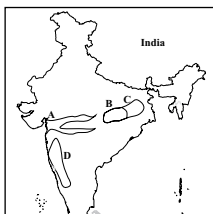
40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

Chota Nagpur Plateau covers much of Jharkhand as well as adjacent parts of Odisha, West Bengal, Bihar and Chhattisgarh.

The Chotanagpur Plateau extends over an area of approximately 86239 sq.km. Chotanagpur consists of a series of plateaus at different levels of elevation. In the Central Western portion, the 'Patland' extended with a height of about 1100 m. Here, the sharp break in slope is marked by steep scarps. Hence it is a front sloping.

6. Consider the map given below :



The places marked A, B, C and D in the map are respectively :

- (a) Rift valley region, Chhattisgarh plain, Rain shadow region and Chota Nagpur
(b) Chhattisgarh Plain, Chota Nagpur plateau, Rift Valley region, and Rain shadow region
(c) Rift Valley region, Chhattisgarh plain, Chota Nagpur plateau and Rain shadow region
(d) Chhattisgarh plain, Rain shadow region, Chota Nagpur plateau and Rift valley region

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

The place marked 'A' on the map is Narmada and Tapi river's rift valley region. The place marked 'B' is Chhattisgarh plain which is drained mostly by Mahanadi river. The place marked 'C' is Chota Nagpur plateau. The place marked 'D' is a rain shadow area which is part of Western Ghat.

7. Which plateau lies between the Aravalli and the Vindhya ranges?

- (a) Malwa Plateau (b) Chotanagpur Plateau
(c) Deccan Plateau (d) Peninsular Plateau

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre), 2008

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

Malwa plateau spreads over an area of 150000 sq .km with a length of 530km and a width of 390 km. Its northern end is determined by Aravalli, southern end by the Vindhya range and eastern border by Bundelkhand plateau.

8. The southern part of the Vindhyan Scarpland is called:

- (a) Amarkantak plateau (b) Maikal plateau
(c) Bhandar plateau (d) Bastar plateau

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

The southern part of the Vindhyan Mountain Range is called the Bhandar plateau. In the northern part of Madhya Pradesh, behind the back slopes of the Vindhya range, there are vast plains, low-height hills and valleys, while the southern region consists of these features. The Bhandar plateau is known for its steep and rugged terrain and is recognized as a part of the Vindhya Mountains.

9. Dandakaranya lies in –

- (a) Chhattisgarh and Madhya Pradesh
(b) Chhattisgarh and Orissa
(c) Jharkhand and Orissa
(d) Andhra Pradesh and Jharkhand

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (b)

The Dandakaranya region occupies an area of about 89078 sq. km in the State of Orissa (now Odisha), Chhattisgarh, Telangana, Maharashtra and Andhra Pradesh. The region extends for about 480km from east to west and 320km from north to south.

10. Dandakaranya region lies in the state of :

- (a) Odisha (b) Chhattisgarh
(c) Andhra Pradesh (d) Telangana
(e) None of the above/more than of the above.

66th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2020

Ans. (e)

See the explanation of the above question.

11. In which part of India, Dandakaranya is situated?

- (a) Northern
- (b) Eastern
- (c) Central
- (d) Western

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

Dandakaranya is a part of India's peninsular plateau. It extends over an area of approximately 89078 sq. km in Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Telangana, Maharashtra and Andhra Pradesh.

12. Which one of the following parts of Bihar is geologically older in age relatively?

- (a) Rohtas Plateau
- (b) North-Western Hills
- (c) Kharagpur Hills
- (d) North Ganga Plains
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

The Kharagpur Hills belong to the Dharwad order, while the Rohtas plateau belongs to the Vindhyan order, the North-Western Hills belong to the Tertiary order and the North Ganga plain is the latest.

13. Which one of the following is not a part of the Meghalaya Plateau?

- (a) Bhuban Hills
- (b) Garo Hills
- (c) Khasi Hills
- (d) Jaintia Hills
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

Garo, Khasi and Jaintia Hills are parts of Meghalaya Plateau whereas Bhuban Hills is located in Barak Valley in Assam.

14. Albama Hill located at

- (a) the west of Bijapur upland
- (b) the east of Bijapur upland
- (c) the south of Bijapur upland
- (d) the north of Bijapur upland

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

Albama Hill is located in the south of Bijapur upland.

15. Consider the following statements about Peninsular plateau.

1. Rising from the height of 150 m above the river plains up to an elevation of 600-900 m is the irregular triangle known as the Peninsular plateau.
2. Delhi ridge in the northwest, the Rajmahal hills in the east, Gir range in the west and the Cardamom hills in the south constitute the outer extent of the Peninsular plateau.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Peninsular Plateau Rising from a height of 150 m above the river plains upto an elevation of 600-900 m is the irregular triangle known as the peninsular plateau. Delhi ridge in the northwest, (extension of the Aravalis), the Rajmahal hills in the east, Gir range in the west and the Cardamom hills in the south constitute the outer extent of the Peninsular plateau. However, an extension of this is also seen in the northeast, in the form of Shillong and Karbi - Anglong plateau. The peninsular India is made up of a series of patland Plateaus such as the Hazaribagh plateau, the Palamu plateau, the Ranchi plateau, the Malwa plateau, the Coimbatore plateau and the Karnataka pleteau etc. This is one of the oldest and the most stable landmasses of India. The general elevation of the plateau is from the west to the east, which is also provend by the pattern of flow of rivers.

16. What are not true about the Peninsular Plateau?

1. Height of this plateau is approximately 1000-1500 meters.
2. Height of this plateau generally decreases from West to East.
3. On its East there are Gir Range and on West there are Rajmahal Hills.

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 and 3
- (c) 1 and 3
- (d) None of the above.

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre), 2022

Ans. (c)

The peninsular plateau rises from a height of 150m above. The river plains up to an elevation of 600-900m, form the irregular triangle known as the Peninsular Plateau. Delhi ridge in the northwest (extension of Aravalis), the Rajmahal hills in the east, Gir range in the west and the Cardamom hills in the south constitute the outer extent of the Peninsular Plateau. The height of this plateau generally decreases from West to East. So statements (1) and (3) are incorrect.